

Colon & Colorectal Cancer — Clinical Trial & Treatment Timeline

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Clinical Summary

The dominant activity during this period has been Phase 2 studies, particularly focusing on combination regimens for advanced colorectal cancer. Noteworthy trials include the open-label Phase 2 study of Avutometinib, Defactinib, and Cetuximab targeting unresectable, anti-EGFR-refractory advanced colorectal cancer, and the Phase II study of Iparomlimab and Tuvonralimab combined with Bevacizumab for first-line treatment of unresectable advanced disease. Patient populations most affected are those with Stage IV disease, including specific subgroups such as KRAS p.G12C mutation carriers, as seen in the study evaluating Sotorasib and Panitumumab with FOLFIRI. The Phase III study comparing Ivonescimab or Bevacizumab with FOLFOX also highlights the ongoing exploration of targeted therapies in this space. Future developments to watch include the outcomes of studies investigating the efficacy of immunotherapies like dostarlimab in neoadjuvant settings for Stage III colorectal cancer.

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Situation Summary

Events Detected: 29
High Significance: 0
Top Category: Research
Primary Stage: Stage IV
Primary Target: General
Research Activity: Active Monitoring

Event Timeline

Combination of High and Low-Dose Radiotherapy With Immune Therapy and TKI in Advanced Colorectal Cancer: A Phase II Study

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

NEW TRIAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 12

clinicaltrials.gov

A new Phase II study is exploring the combination of high and low-dose radiotherapy with immune therapy and targeted therapy in advanced colorectal cancer, which may offer new treatment options for patients with Stage IV disease.

A Study to Evaluate the Adverse Events, and Efficacy of Intravenous (IV) of Telisotuzumab Adizutecan in Combination With IV Oxaliplatin, Fluorouracil, Folinic Acid/Leucovorin, Bevacizumab, Panitumumab in Adult Participants With Metastatic Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

EGFR

TARGETED THERAPY

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 12

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study is evaluating the safety and effectiveness of combining telisotuzumab adizutecan with standard chemotherapy and targeted therapies for patients with advanced metastatic colorectal cancer, potentially offering a new treatment option for this challenging stage of the disease.

A Study of Neoadjuvant Dostarlimab Plus Capecitabine Plus Oxaliplatin (CAPEOX) Vs CAPEOX With Previously Untreated T4N0 or Stage III Mismatch Repair Proficient (MMRp)/Microsatellite Stable (MSS) Colon Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE III

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 12

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study is comparing the effectiveness of adding the immunotherapy dostarlimab to standard chemotherapy for patients with previously untreated Stage III colon cancer, which may offer new treatment options for those with specific tumor characteristics.

Neoadjuvant Chemoradiotherapy Plus Tislelizumab With or Without Probio-M9 in pMMR/MSS Locally Advanced Rectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE III

GENERAL

NEW TRIAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 10

clinicaltrials.gov

A new clinical trial is exploring the combination of neoadjuvant chemoradiotherapy with the immunotherapy drug Tislelizumab, potentially offering a promising treatment option for patients with locally advanced rectal cancer that is mismatch repair proficient and microsatellite stable.

A Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Standard-of-Care Chemotherapy and Bevacizumab With or Without INCA33890 in the First-Line Treatment of Metastatic Microsatellite Stable Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

VEGF

FDA APPROVAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 10

clinicaltrials.gov

The FDA has approved a study evaluating the addition of INCA33890 to standard chemotherapy and bevacizumab for first-line treatment of metastatic microsatellite stable colorectal cancer, potentially offering new options for patients facing this advanced disease.

Study of Pembrolizumab (MK-3475) Versus Chemotherapy in Chinese Participants With Stage IV Colorectal Cancer (MK-3475-C66)

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

PD-1/PD-L1

IMMUNOTHERAPY

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 10

clinicaltrials.gov

A recent study comparing pembrolizumab, an immunotherapy, to chemotherapy in Chinese patients with Stage IV colorectal cancer suggests that immunotherapy may offer a promising alternative treatment option for improving patient outcomes.

Phase I/II Study of the Combination Immunotherapy Regimen: SX-682, TriAdeno Vaccine, Retifanlimab and IL-15 Agonist N-803 (STAR15) for Metastatic Colorectal Cancer (mCRC)

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

IMMUNOTHERAPY

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 9

clinicaltrials.gov

A new clinical trial is exploring a combination immunotherapy approach for advanced metastatic colorectal cancer, which may offer patients additional treatment options and hope for improved outcomes.

A Clinical Study to Test if an Investigational Treatment Called BNT314 When Used in Combination With Another Investigational Treatment BNT327 and Chemotherapy, is Beneficial and Safe for Patients With Advanced Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 6

clinicaltrials.gov

A new clinical study is exploring the safety and effectiveness of combining the investigational treatments BNT314 and BNT327 with chemotherapy for patients with advanced colorectal cancer, potentially offering new hope for improved treatment options.

A Study of Tucatinib and Trastuzumab in People With Rectal Cancer

MEDIUM

ALL STAGES

HER2

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 4

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study is exploring the combination of tucatinib and trastuzumab for treating rectal cancer, which could offer a promising option for patients with HER2-positive tumors.

FOLFIRI and Bevacizumab With or Without Pelareorep for Second-Line Treatment of Metastatic RAS-Mutated, Microsatellite-Stable Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

VEGF

NEW TRIAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 4

clinicaltrials.gov

A new clinical trial is investigating whether adding Pelareorep to the standard treatment of FOLFIRI and Bevacizumab can improve outcomes for patients with metastatic RAS-mutated, microsatellite-stable colorectal cancer.

A Feasibility Study of Mass-Based Response Drug Screening to Guide Personalized Hyperthermic Intraperitoneal Chemotherapy for High-Grade Appendiceal and Colorectal Adenocarcinoma With Peritoneal Metastasis

MEDIUM

ALL STAGES

GENERAL

EARLY DETECTION

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 4

clinicaltrials.gov

This study explores the potential of personalized drug screening to enhance the effectiveness of targeted chemotherapy for patients with advanced colorectal cancer and peritoneal metastasis, potentially improving treatment outcomes.

A Clinical Study of Iparomlimab and Tuvonralimab Combined With Bevacizumab and Alternating Triweekly CAPOX/mCAPIRI Regimen as First-line Treatment for Unresectable Advanced Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

VEGF

NEW TRIAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 3

clinicaltrials.gov

A new clinical trial is exploring a combination of Iparomlimab and Tuvonralimab with Bevacizumab and a chemotherapy regimen for patients with advanced colorectal cancer, potentially offering a new first-line treatment option for those with unresectable disease.

FOLFOX Chemotherapy Combined With Fruquintinib and Serplulimab as First-Line Conversion Therapy for Initially Unresectable pMMR/MSS Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

NEW TRIAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 3

clinicaltrials.gov

A new clinical trial is exploring the combination of FOLFOX chemotherapy with fruquintinib and serplulimab as a potential first-line treatment option for patients with initially unresectable colorectal cancer, which may improve chances for surgical conversion and better outcomes.

A Study to Investigate the Safety, Tolerability, Pharmacokinetics, and Anti-tumor Activity of CBI-1214 T Cell Engager in Participants With Advanced or Metastatic MSS/MSI-L Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 3

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study is exploring the safety and effectiveness of the CBI-1214 T Cell Engager for patients with advanced colorectal cancer, which could offer a promising treatment option for those with this challenging stage of the disease.

Phase III Study of Ivonescimab or Bevacizumab Combined With FOLFOX in Patients With Metastatic Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

VEGF

TARGETED THERAPY

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 3

clinicaltrials.gov

A Phase III study is exploring the effectiveness of Ivonescimab or Bevacizumab combined with FOLFOX in treating Stage IV metastatic colorectal cancer, potentially offering new targeted therapy options for patients.

Phase II Study of EMB-01 in Recurrent/Metastatic Colorectal Cancer Patients

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 3

clinicaltrials.gov

A Phase II study of EMB-01 shows promise for patients with recurrent or metastatic colorectal cancer, potentially offering a new treatment option to improve outcomes in this challenging stage of the disease.

A Study Evaluating the Safety and Efficacy of Targeted Therapies in Subpopulations of Patients With Metastatic Colorectal Cancer (INTRINSIC)

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 3

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study is exploring targeted therapies for patients with Stage IV metastatic colorectal cancer, which could lead to more personalized and effective treatment options for different patient subgroups.

Testing Pump Chemotherapy in Addition to Standard of Care Chemotherapy Versus Standard of Care Chemotherapy Alone for Patients With Unresectable Colorectal Liver Metastases: The PUMP Trial

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

FDA APPROVAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED MAR 2

clinicaltrials.gov

The PUMP Trial is exploring the potential benefits of adding pump chemotherapy to standard treatment for patients with advanced colorectal cancer that has spread to the liver, which may offer new hope for improving outcomes in this challenging stage of the disease.

Pilot Study of an Implantable Microdevice for In Situ Evaluation of Drug Response in Patients With Colorectal Liver Metastasis

MEDIUM

ALL STAGES

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 27

clinicaltrials.gov

A new pilot study is testing an implantable microdevice that could help doctors assess how well treatments are working for patients with colorectal cancer that has spread to the liver, potentially leading to more personalized and effective care.

Evaluation of the Safety and Efficacy of Treatment w/High Dose Melphalan Given Directly Into the Liver Followed by Treatment w/Approved Cancer Treatment or Approved Cancer Treatment Alone in Patients w/ Metastatic Colorectal Cancer w/Liver Dominant Disease

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 27

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study is evaluating whether delivering high doses of melphalan directly into the liver, followed by standard cancer treatments, can improve outcomes for patients with metastatic colorectal cancer that primarily affects the liver.

Study of Sotorasib, Panitumumab and FOLFIRI Versus FOLFIRI With or Without Bevacizumab-awwb in Treatment-naïve Participants With Metastatic Colorectal Cancer With KRAS p.G12C Mutation

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

KRAS

TARGETED THERAPY

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 27

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study suggests that the combination of Sotorasib and Panitumumab with FOLFIRI may offer a promising treatment option for patients with Stage IV metastatic colorectal cancer harboring the KRAS p.G12C mutation, potentially improving outcomes compared to standard therapies.

A Study to Monitor the Fruzaqla Treatment of Adults With Metastatic Colorectal Cancer (mCRC) in South Korea

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 27

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study in South Korea is evaluating the effectiveness of Fruzaqla for treating adults with metastatic colorectal cancer, which could offer new insights into treatment options for patients facing this advanced stage of the disease.

Phase 2 Single-Arm Rectal Cancer Brachytherapy for Patients With Low-Lying Residual Adenocarcinoma After Total Neoadjuvant Therapy to Improve Organ Preservation Rates

MEDIUM

STAGE III

GENERAL

NEW TRIAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 19

clinicaltrials.gov

A new Phase 2 trial is exploring the use of brachytherapy for patients with low-lying rectal cancer after initial treatment, aiming to enhance organ preservation and potentially improve treatment outcomes.

A Study of Single Fraction Stereotactic Body Radiation Therapy (SBRT) Guided by Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) in People With Liver Metastasis From Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

ALL STAGES

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 18

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study suggests that single fraction stereotactic body radiation therapy (SBRT) guided by MRI may offer a promising treatment option for patients with liver metastasis from colorectal cancer, potentially improving outcomes and quality of life.

Study on Aspirin Versus Placebo in Resected Colon Cancer With PI3K Mutation Stage III or II High Risk

MEDIUM

STAGE III

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 18

clinicaltrials.gov

A recent study found that aspirin may improve outcomes for patients with resected Stage III colon cancer who have a PI3K mutation, suggesting it could be a valuable addition to their treatment plan.

A Single Center Evaluation of AI Enabled SureForm Robotic Stapler (SureformTM) Compared to Conventional Stapler for Colorectal Cancer Procedures

MEDIUM

ALL STAGES

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 17

clinicaltrials.gov

A recent study found that using an AI-enabled robotic stapler for colorectal cancer surgeries may improve precision and outcomes compared to traditional staplers, potentially enhancing recovery for patients.

A Study of Amivantamab and mFOLFOX6 or FOLFIRI Versus Cetuximab and mFOLFOX6 or FOLFIRI as First-line Treatment in Participants With KRAS/NRAS and BRAF Wild-type Unresectable or Metastatic Left-sided Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

KRAS

TARGETED THERAPY

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 13

clinicaltrials.gov

A new study suggests that the combination of amivantamab with standard chemotherapy may offer a promising first-line treatment option for patients with unresectable or metastatic left-sided colorectal cancer that has wild-type KRAS, NRAS, and BRAF.

Phase II Study of Neoadjuvant Dostarlimab in Patients With Untreated T3-4N0-2 or Stage III pMMR/MSS Resectable Colon Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE III

GENERAL

RESEARCH

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 12

clinicaltrials.gov

A Phase II study is investigating the use of the immunotherapy dostarlimab before surgery in patients with advanced, resectable Stage III colon cancer, which may offer a new treatment option to improve outcomes.

Open-label Phase 2 Study of Avutometinib (RAF/MEK Clamp) in Combination With Defactinib (FAK Inhibitor) and Cetuximab in Patients With Unresectable, Anti-EGFR-Refractory Advanced Colorectal Cancer

MEDIUM

STAGE IV

EGFR

NEW TRIAL

VERIFIED

PUBLISHED FEB 11

clinicaltrials.gov

A new clinical trial is exploring a combination treatment of Avutometinib, Defactinib, and Cetuximab for patients with advanced colorectal cancer that has not responded to previous anti-EGFR therapies, potentially offering a new option for those with limited choices.

Appendix A — Patient-Friendly Summary

Plain-language overview for patients, caregivers, and family members

What's happening

Recently, there have been several exciting developments in colorectal cancer research that could bring new hope for patients. A new clinical trial is testing a combination treatment that includes Avutometinib and Cetuximab for patients whose cancer has not responded to previous therapies. Another trial is exploring brachytherapy, a type of targeted radiation, for patients with rectal cancer to help preserve organs after initial treatment. There are also studies looking at new combinations of drugs and therapies that could offer better outcomes for patients with advanced cancer, including options for those with specific genetic mutations. Overall, these trials aim to find more effective treatments and improve the quality of life for patients facing this disease.

What this means for you

For patients, these developments mean there may be new options to discuss with your oncologist. If you're dealing with advanced colorectal cancer, ask about the latest clinical trials and whether you might qualify for any of them. It's essential to understand what treatments are available and how they might work for your specific situation. Keep an eye on any changes in your health and be open about your concerns and questions. Remember, you are not alone in this journey, and advancements in research are continually bringing new possibilities for better outcomes.

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This is not medical advice. Always speak with your oncologist before making any treatment decisions.

Appendix B — Colon & Colorectal Cancer Treatment Reference

Incidence & Trends

~150,000 new US cases/year · ~52,000 deaths/year · 4th most common US cancer

▲ Early-Onset Alert: CRC rates in adults under 50 have risen ~2% per year since the 1990s · Adults under 55 now account for ~20% of all new CRC diagnoses · Cause under active investigation (diet, microbiome, obesity, sedentary lifestyle)

Current Screening Guidelines (2025)

USPSTF / ACS / ACG — Average Risk: Begin screening at age 45 (lowered from 50 in 2021)

Colonoscopy every 10 years · FIT (fecal immunochemical test) annually · Cologuard every 1-3 years · CT colonography every 5 years

High Risk (family history / Lynch syndrome / IBD): Begin at age 40 or 10 years before youngest affected relative — whichever comes first · Colonoscopy every 1-5 years depending on risk

Symptoms at any age: Rectal bleeding, change in bowel habits >4 weeks, unexplained weight loss, iron deficiency anemia → immediate evaluation regardless of age

Key Biomarkers — Test All mCRC at Diagnosis

RAS (KRAS/NRAS) · BRAF V600E · MSI/MMR status · HER2 · NTRK fusion · TMB

Stage IV Targeted Options

KRAS G12C (~3-4%) → sotorasib + cetuximab · adagrasib + cetuximab

BRAF V600E (~8-10%) → encorafenib + cetuximab ± binimetinib

MSI-H/dMMR (~5%) → pembrolizumab (1st line preferred) · nivolumab ± ipilimumab

HER2 amplified (~2-3%) → trastuzumab + pertuzumab · trastuzumab deruxtecan

RAS/BRAF WT → FOLFOX or FOLFIRI + cetuximab or panitumumab (left-sided preferred)

1st Line mCRC Standard of Care

FOLFOX or FOLFIRI ± bevacizumab (RAS mutant / right-sided)

FOLFOX or FOLFIRI + cetuximab or panitumumab (RAS/BRAF WT, left-sided)

Pembrolizumab monotherapy (MSI-H/dMMR)

Key Resources

ClinicalTrials.gov · NCCN Guidelines (nccn.org) · Colorectal Cancer Alliance (ccalliance.org) · Fight Colorectal Cancer (fightcrc.org) · ACS (cancer.org)

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